

Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

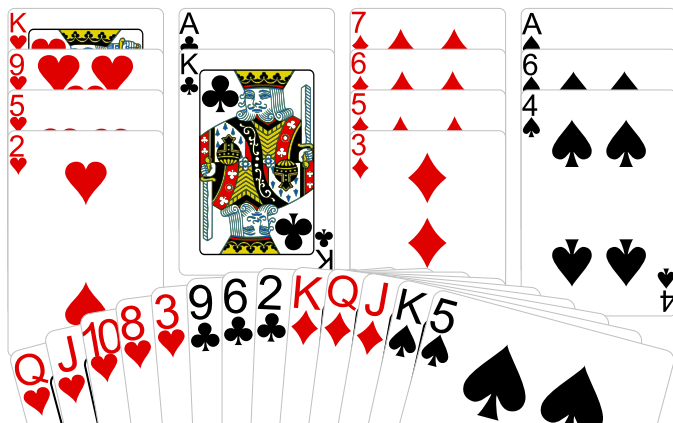
respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



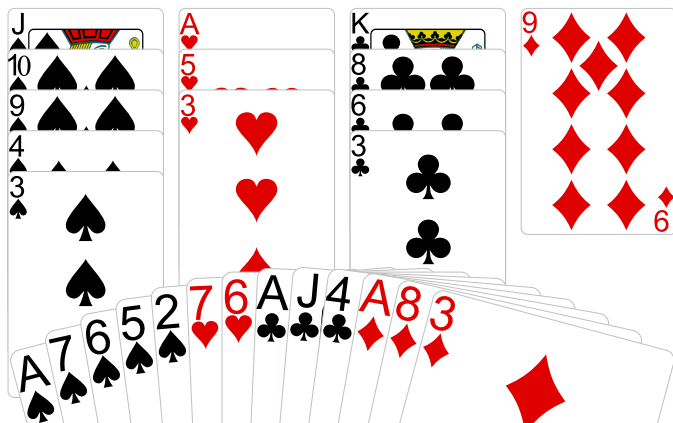
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



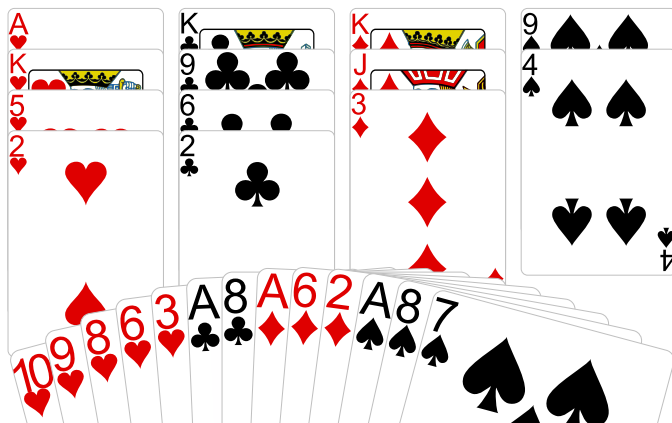
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 6♠
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 8 2
♥ A 6
♦ A T 4
♣ T 8 5 3

12
9 5
14

♠ K 5
♥ Q J T 8 3
♦ K Q J
♣ 9 6 2



♠ A 6 4
♥ K 9 5 2
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ A K

♠ Q T 7 3
♥ 7 4
♦ 9 8 2
♣ Q J 7 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North
♥

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NORTH has a minimum 1



opening bid - 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH also has opening hand strength, 14 points for him. He also has four of NORTH's



s. He applies the "He who knows, goes" principle and

bids 4

.

IMPORTANT NOTE: Most experienced bridge pairs would not bid the hand quite this way, although they

would arrive at the same contract. See some of the other BakerBridge lessons for more details.

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K Q 9 2
♥ Q J
♦ Q 7 6 4
♣ J 8 4

6
11 19
4

West

3 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

♠ 5 3
♥ 9 6
♦ T 9 8 5 2
♣ A Q 7 5



♠ 6
♥ T 8 7 4 3 2
♦ J
♣ K T 6 3 2

North

Pass

East

1 ♠

6 ♠

South

Pass

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EAST has a powerful hand (21 points) with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1 ♠.

WEST has an 11-point Limit Raise with four trumps. She jumps to 3 ♠.

EAST now knows that the partnership holds at least 32 points, perhaps 33. Since he can see that

the opponents have no way to win the first two tricks he decides to bid the slam, 6 ♠

Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ -
♥ Q J T 8
♦ K T 7 4 2
♣ Q 9 7 2

8
8 11
13

♠ J T 9 4 3
♥ A 5 3
♦ 9
♣ K 8 6 3



♠ A 7 6 5 2
♥ 7 6
♦ A 8 3
♣ A J 4

♠ K Q 8
♥ K 9 4 2
♦ Q J 6 5
♣ T 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♠		1♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

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SOUTH has 14 points and opens 1♠, her 5-card Major.

NORTH could bid 3♠, a Limit Raise with his 11 points. But it is often a good idea,

when you have five of the Major suit that partner opened with, to just go ahead and bid

the game. So North should bid 4♠ here.

See the NOTE in Deal 13. When you use weaker 5-card support hands for your jump to game, you

need to find another way to describe your opening-hand-strength type hands.

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 8 7
♥ T 9 8 6 3
♦ A 6 2
♣ A 8

6
12 14
8

♠ K J T
♥ J 7 4
♦ 9 7 4
♣ J T 7 3



♠ Q 6 5 3 2
♥ Q
♦ Q T 8 5
♣ Q 5 4

♠ 9 4
♥ A K 5 2
♦ K J 3
♣ K 9 6 2

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WEST has 13 points so he must open. He has five



s so he

should open 1



.

West

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by West

North

Pass

East

4 ♥

South

EAST, with 14 points and four



s knows there are

enough points for a game contract and at least nine



s between

the partners. She who KNOWS, GOES, so EAST bids 4



.

This is similar to Deal 13.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A T 6 4
♥ T 2
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ T 8 3

19
5 4
12

♠ K 9
♥ A K J 6 5
♦ A T 5
♣ A 7 6



♠ Q 8 2
♥ Q 8 4 3
♦ K 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ J 7 5 3
♥ 9 7
♦ Q 8 6
♣ J 9 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥		3 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

take the safe position and just bid 4



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NORTH has 20 points, a pretty strong hand to open 1



.

SOUTH has 12 points, and makes a Limit Raise, a jump to 3



.

NORTH is very, very close to bidding a slam. But she knows SOUTH has 12 points at most, so she should

Deal 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 8 7 4 2
 ♥ K Q 3
 ♦ 8 6
 ♣ 9 5

10
 7 12
 11

♠ T
 ♥ 8 7 6 4
 ♦ T
 ♣ A K Q J 8 3 2

♠ A J 6 5 3
 ♥ J T 9
 ♦ A Q 5 4
 ♣ 6

♠ K
 ♥ A 5 2
 ♦ K J 9 7 3 2
 ♣ T 7 4



West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			
4 ♠ by East			

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WEST passes to start with since he only has 9 points.

EAST naturally opens 1 ♠ with her 13 point, 5-card ♠ suit hand.

WEST might now make a Limit Raise since his hand is now worth 11 points because of the

two doubletons. However, with six trumps he should jump all the way to 4 ♠.